

Slack Field Guide

Slack answers almost everything with HTTP 200 and puts the failure in the body as `ok: false`, so a bot that never posted looks like one that did. Every script here is read only.

8 fixes, each one a written note with diagrams and a small Python and Node.js script that finds the problem and repairs it. All 8 have a script in the public repo.

Before you run anything. Every script starts in a dry run: it reports what it would change and writes nothing. Read that output first, then set `DRY_RUN=false` when you are satisfied it has understood your data.

Scripts: github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes

Guides: allanninal.dev/slack

All 14 repos: github.com/allanninal

The fixes

1 the bot answers its own messages in an endless loop

A channel fills with hundreds of identical bot messages in a few seconds. Slack starts rate-limiting the app, which slows the flood without stopping it, and in the end somebody removes the bot from the channel to make it stop. The cause is one line that was never written: the handler subscribed to `message.channels`, which delivers every message in the channel, including the one the app posted a moment ago.

[slack_echo_loop_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/bot-message-echo-loop/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/bot-message-echo-loop>

2 not_in_channel: the bot was never invited to the channel

The app is installed. The token authenticates. The channel ID was copied out of the URL and is correct. Every call still comes back `{"ok": false, "error": "not_in_channel"}`, because installing an app to a workspace does not put it in a single channel — and this is, by view count, the most-asked Slack API question there is.

[slack_channel_membership.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/bot-not-in-channel/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/bot-not-in-channel>

3 the same message posted three times, and the ts says why

The alert channel has the same incident in it four times. Every one of those messages is a real, successful `chat.postMessage` call that returned `ok: true` and a distinct `ts`, so nothing failed and nothing will appear in your error tracker. The duplicates are not a display bug — they are four separate decisions your system made to send, and the record of all four is sitting in `conversations.history` waiting to be read.

[slack_duplicate_messages.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/duplicate-messages-no-dedupe/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/duplicate-messages-no-dedupe>

4 slack answers HTTP 200 and puts the failure in the body

The deploy is green. The log line reads `POST https://slack.com/api/chat.postMessage 200`. Nothing has appeared in the channel for three weeks. When somebody finally logs the response body it reads `{"ok": false, "error": "not_in_channel"}` — and it has read that, unchanged, every single time.

[slack_ok_false_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/http-200-ok-false/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/http-200-ok-false>

5 missing_scope tells you the scope needed and the ones you have

`{"ok": false, "error": "missing_scope", "needed": "channels:history", "provided": "chat:write,commands,users:read"}`. The developer swears the scope is in the app configuration, and it is — but the app was never reinstalled, so the token in production still carries the grant it was issued with.

[slack_scope_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/missing-scope-on-read/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/missing-scope-on-read>

6 conversations.history clamped to 15 objects and 1 per minute

A backfill that used to take an hour now takes weeks, and nothing in your code changed. `conversations.history` still returns `ok: true`, still returns a valid page, still gives you a cursor — it just returns 15 messages when you asked for 200, and refuses the second call inside the same minute. This is Slack's May 2025 rate-limit change for apps that are not approved for the Marketplace, and it is working exactly as designed.

[slack_history_clamp_probe.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/non-marketplace-history-clamp/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/non-marketplace-history-clamp>

7 next_cursor is ignored so only the first page is ever seen

The channel inventory has exactly 100 entries. So does the user directory. Nobody questions either number until somebody reports that a channel which plainly exists is missing from the report — and by then the sync has been dropping four fifths of the workspace every night for a year, with `ok: true` on every single response.

[slack_pagination_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/pagination-not-followed/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/pagination-not-followed>

8 files made public with a link that works without a Slack login

Nothing errored, and nothing is going to. Somewhere in the app's history a developer needed an image URL that Block Kit could actually fetch, called `files.sharedPublicURL`, and it worked. Every file that call has been made against since — customer exports, database dumps, screenshots with a token still on screen — is readable by anyone holding the link, with no Slack account, no workspace membership and no expiry. The flag is on each file, and `files.list` will hand you all of them.

[slack_public_files_audit.py](#)

<https://www.allanninal.dev/slack/public-file-links-exposed/>

<https://github.com/allanninal/slack-fixes/tree/main/public-file-links-exposed>
